

D024

Professional Presence and Influence

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

On a busy oncology unit with new glass doors, a nurse enters a room, charts on the computer with her back to the patient, and answers questions without looking up. She has worked on the unit for nine years. Which change best shows presence?

- A. Turn to face the patient, make eye contact, and listen fully before charting.
- B. Always complete charting in the room so the patient is never alone.
- C. Stay in the room longer while charting.
- D. Rely on her nine years of experience to anticipate needs without asking.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A patient who likes to talk about gardening asks her nurse about his weekend. The nurse, who recently moved from another state, spends ten minutes describing his own divorce. Which statement best describes the problem?

- A. It was fine because it built a friendship.
- B. The nurse should have talked about gardening instead.
- C. The conversation shifted focus from the patient's needs to the nurse's.
- D. The nurse should never answer any personal question.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which nurse response keeps the relationship therapeutic when a patient asks, “Do you have kids?”

- A. A detailed story about the nurse's children's school problems.
- B. “I do. What made you think about kids today?”
- C. “Why do you want to know?”
- D. “That's personal; we don't discuss that.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A long-term patient, a retired teacher who loves crossword puzzles, asks her nurse to keep a secret from the care team and to visit her at home after discharge. The nurse agrees and starts giving her extra time other patients do not get. What best describes this?

- A. Acceptable, because the patient asked.
- B. A boundary violation, because the relationship now serves personal ends and risks harm.
- C. A boundary crossing, because it is well meant.
- D. Not a concern, because she is a retired teacher.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation is a boundary crossing rather than a violation?

- A. Starting a dating relationship with a current patient.
- B. Keeping a patient's secret from the team.
- C. Lending money to a patient.
- D. Briefly holding a grieving patient's hand at the moment of bad news.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A charge nurse starts a two-minute mindfulness practice at the start of each shift in the staff lounge, which has a large window. One nurse says she failed because her mind kept wandering to her patient list. What is the best response?

- A. Noticing the wandering and gently returning to the breath is the practice itself.
- B. She should keep trying until she can stop all thoughts.
- C. Mindfulness does not work for busy nurses.
- D. She should practice facing away from the window.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A hospice nurse who has worked nights for three years feels numb and dreads hearing more patients' stories of loss. Her unit has good staffing and a supportive manager. She drives a long commute. What best explains her symptoms?

- A. Burnout from poor staffing.
- B. Burnout from the long commute.
- C. Normal tiredness that never needs support.
- D. Compassion fatigue from repeated exposure to patients' suffering.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse on a unit with chronic understaffing, forced overtime, and no say in scheduling feels exhausted and cynical, though she finds patient care meaningful. Which term fits best?

- A. Compassion fatigue.
- B. Depression, so staffing is irrelevant.
- C. Burnout.
- D. Moral injury from a single event.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A new graduate on a surgical unit proudly skips meals and works extra shifts to show commitment. She keeps a color-coded planner and has won a unit award. Which statement reflects the profession's view?

- A. Her award shows she is doing well.
- B. Self-care only matters after work hours.
- C. Caring for her own health is a professional duty that supports safe patient care.
- D. Skipping breaks shows the dedication patients need.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A patient with a new cancer diagnosis says, "I don't know how I'll tell my kids." The room is decorated with cards from her book club. Which reply shows empathy?

- A. "It sounds like you're worried about how to share this with them."
- B. "Don't worry, kids are always resilient."
- C. "I feel so sorry for you."
- D. "Your book club will help you."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse tells a grieving family member, "You poor thing, I feel terrible for you." Which label fits, and what would shift it?

- A. Empathy, because it expresses emotion.
- B. Therapeutic, because any kind statement is therapeutic.
- C. Sympathy; the fix is to change the subject to practical tasks.
- D. Sympathy; reflecting the person's own feeling, such as "This loss sounds overwhelming," would make it empathy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Staff on a medical unit report low morale, citing broken equipment, frequent charting double entry, and no voice in scheduling. The unit recently got new paint and artwork. What should the nurse leader do first?

- A. Tell staff morale is a personal choice.
- B. Ask staff what matters to them and work with them to remove the barriers they name.
- C. Enroll staff in a resilience class so they can cope better.
- D. Add more artwork to lift the mood.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

On a busy oncology unit ~~with new glass doors~~, a nurse enters a room, charts on the computer with her back to the patient, and answers questions without looking up. ~~She has worked on the unit for nine years.~~ Which change best shows presence?

Target word: behavior that shows presence **Decides:** Presence is attentive engagement, not just being in the room.

A	Correct	Attentive, whole-person engagement is presence.
B	Absolute language	Rigid rule; the issue is attention, not location of charting.
C	Dropped element	More time alone does not create presence without attention.
D	Camouflage	Experience does not replace attentive listening.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A patient ~~who likes to talk about gardening~~ asks her nurse about his weekend. The nurse, ~~who recently moved from another state~~, spends ten minutes describing his own divorce. Which statement best describes the problem?

Target word: what went wrong **Decides:** The conversation shifted to the nurse's needs.

A	Inverted operation	Friendship is a social relationship goal, not a therapeutic one.
B	Camouflage	Topic choice is not the core issue; whose needs are served is.
C	Correct	A therapeutic relationship stays centered on the patient.
D	Absolute language	Brief, purposeful self-disclosure can be appropriate.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

Which nurse response keeps the relationship therapeutic when a patient asks, "Do you have kids?"

Target word: choose therapeutic response **Decides:** Brief disclosure then return focus to patient.

A	Inverted operation	Shifts focus to the nurse's needs.
B	Correct	Brief, honest answer that returns focus to the patient.
C	Adjacent category	Probing "why" questions can sound defensive and block communication.
D	Absolute language	Shuts down rapport; brief disclosure is not forbidden.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A long-term patient, ~~a retired teacher who loves crossword puzzles~~, asks her nurse to keep a secret from the care team and to visit her at home after discharge. The nurse agrees and starts giving her extra time other patients do not get. What best describes this?

Target word: crossing vs. violation **Decides:** Secrets, special treatment, and personal contact after discharge.

A	Adjacent category	The nurse, not the patient, is responsible for boundaries.
B	Correct	Secrecy, favoritism, and outside contact are warning signs of a violation.
C	Confusion set	Good intent does not turn a violation into a crossing.
D	Camouflage	Patient background does not decide the boundary issue.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

Which situation is a boundary crossing rather than a violation?

Target word: identify a crossing **Decides:** Brief, purposeful, returns to therapeutic focus.

A	Inverted operation	Clear violation serving the nurse's needs.
B	Adjacent category	Secrecy is a red flag for violation.
C	Confusion set	Financial ties exploit the power gap: a violation.
D	Correct	A short, purposeful act for the patient that returns to the normal relationship.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A charge nurse starts a two-minute mindfulness practice at the start of each shift in the staff lounge, ~~which has a large window~~. One nurse says she failed because her mind kept wandering to her patient list. What is the best response?

Target word: correct view of mindfulness **Decides:** Noticing and returning attention without judgment is the practice.

A	Correct	Mindfulness is nonjudgmental attention, including noticing distraction.
B	Confusion set	Mindfulness does not require an empty mind.
C	Absolute language	Sweeping claim unsupported by the scenario.
D	Camouflage	The window is not why she thinks she failed.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A hospice nurse who has worked nights for three years feels numb and dreads hearing more patients' stories of loss. Her unit has good staffing and a supportive manager. ~~She drives a long commute~~. What best explains her symptoms?

Target word: name the condition **Decides:** Symptoms tied to repeated exposure to suffering, with a supportive workplace.

A	Inverted operation	The stem says staffing is good; burnout stems from workplace stressors.
B	Camouflage	The commute does not explain dread tied to patient stories.
C	Absolute language	Dismisses a recognized condition.
D	Correct	The source is secondary trauma, not system strain.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A nurse on a unit with chronic understaffing, forced overtime, and no say in scheduling feels exhausted and cynical, though she finds patient care meaningful. Which term fits best?

Target word: name the condition from the source **Decides:** Workplace stressors, not patient suffering.

A	Inverted operation	That stems from exposure to suffering, which she still finds meaningful.
B	Confusion set	Jumps to a clinical label and ignores the named source.
C	Correct	Chronic workload and lack of control are the classic burnout sources.
D	Adjacent category	A related but different concept tied to violating one's values.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A new graduate on a surgical unit proudly skips meals and works extra shifts to show commitment. ~~She keeps a color-coded planner and has won a unit award.~~ Which statement reflects the profession's view?

Target word: view of self-care **Decides:** Nurses owe themselves the same duty of health and safety as others.

A	Camouflage	Recognition does not decide whether her practice is safe.
B	Absolute language	Breaks and meals during shifts also matter.
C	Correct	Self-care is part of ethical practice, not optional.
D	Inverted operation	Fatigue raises error risk; it is not a virtue.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A patient with a new cancer diagnosis says, "I don't know how I'll tell my kids." ~~The room is decorated with cards from her book club.~~ Which reply shows empathy?

Target word: empathic reply **Decides:** Reflect the patient's feeling from her view.

A	Correct	Reflects her feeling from her perspective.
B	Absolute language	False reassurance with absolute language.
C	Confusion set	Sympathy: the nurse's feeling about her, not reflection of hers.
D	Camouflage	Answers the cards and skips her concern.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A nurse tells a grieving family member, "You poor thing, I feel terrible for you." Which label fits, and what would shift it?

Target word: label the response and its fix **Decides:** The nurse speaks from her own feeling, not the family member's.

A	Confusion set	Expressing emotion is not the same as reflecting the other's feeling.
B	Absolute language	Not every kind statement is therapeutic.
C	Inverted operation	Moving away from feelings is the opposite of empathy.
D	Correct	Sympathy is feeling for someone; empathy reflects their view.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Staff on a medical unit report low morale, citing broken equipment, frequent charting double entry, and no voice in scheduling. ~~The unit recently got new paint and artwork.~~ What should the nurse leader do first?

Target word: first leader action **Decides:** Ask staff what matters and fix system barriers.

A	Inverted operation	Places system problems back on individuals.
B	Correct	Joy in work starts with listening and fixing system problems.
C	Adjacent category	Individual coping does not fix system barriers.
D	Camouflage	Cosmetic changes miss the named problems.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Presence	Presence is full, attentive engagement with the whole person (holism, intimacy, sensitivity, adaptability), not just completing tasks in the room.	Equating time spent at the bedside with presence.	A nurse physically present but focused on screens or tasks.
2	Therapeutic vs. social relationship	A therapeutic relationship is purposeful and centered on the patient's needs; the nurse's needs are met elsewhere.	Treating mutual sharing and friendship as the goal of the relationship.	The nurse's own stories or needs taking up the conversation.
3	Boundary crossing vs. violation	A crossing is a brief, purposeful departure that returns to the relationship; a violation serves the nurse's needs and harms or exploits the patient.	Calling every departure from routine a violation, or none of them.	Secret-keeping, special favors, or contact outside the care role.
4	Mindfulness	Mindfulness is paying attention on purpose to the present moment without judgment.	Believing mindfulness means emptying the mind or stopping all thoughts.	A wandering mind described as failure.
5	Compassion fatigue vs. burnout	Compassion fatigue comes from repeated exposure to others' suffering and trauma; burnout comes from chronic workplace stressors such as workload and lack of control.	Using the two terms as the same thing.	The named source: patient suffering vs. staffing, workload, or system strain.
6	Self-care as a professional duty	Nurses owe the same duty to promote health and safety to themselves as to others; self-care supports ethical, safe care.	Viewing self-care as selfish or optional.	A nurse skipping breaks and sleep to prove commitment.
7	Empathy vs. sympathy	Empathy is understanding and reflecting the patient's feelings from their view; sympathy is feeling sorry for them from your own view.	Calling any kind or sad response empathy.	"I feel so sorry for you" vs. "It sounds like you feel..."
8	Joy in work	Leaders restore joy in work by asking staff what matters to them and fixing the system barriers they name.	Offering individual resilience classes as the whole answer to system problems.	A unit-wide morale problem tied to workflow or staffing.

Course scope (public description): Professional Presence and Influence is a masters-level course designed to guide students towards an enhanced state of presence, where therapeutic relationships are built between nurse and patient. Students will learn techniques for self-care practices that result in enhanced mental and physical wellbeing and that ensure ethically-generated patient care. Presence is an intrapersonal and interpersonal quality that allows the nurse to relate to others and to be aware of the world around them. The characteristics of presence, which include holism, intimacy, sensitivity and adaptability, create a heightened sense of awareness that fosters therapeutic relationships between the nurse and patient. Developing a mindful, authentic presence is central to health and spiritual practices in several cultures and a major element of leadership. Students will intentionally develop a focused mindfulness practice that will influence patient outcomes and lead to conditions that create joy in the workplace.